Week 4 Milestone Worksheet

Instructions: This worksheet will help you complete your Week 4 Milestone slide deck, so complete it before you start putting your deck together. Each part of this worksheet must correspond to the content that you will place into your finished slide deck.

In order to complete the assignment, you must follow these steps:

1. Complete this worksheet with the content that you will put on each slide.
2. Create a deck on Google Slides or Canva.
3. Copy and paste content from this worksheet into your slide deck, creating slides in line with the instructions shared in the Milestone.
4. Add any missing visuals to your slides in line with the instructions in the Milestone.
5. Make sure your slide deck is aesthetically pleasing and well-designed.
6. Get the share link to your slide deck, and add it here at the end of this worksheet. Make sure that the link is viewable by everyone.
7. Save, and submit this worksheet on Savanna.

SECTION A: SLIDE DECK CONTENT

Slide 1: Your Problem Statement

State your problem in 1 sentence. Your problem should be a sub-component of a GCGO. (As stated above, we recommend you use the same problem/GCGO as last

week, but you can change it if you wish to re-do the steps in Week 3 Milestone.) For example, if your GCGO was climate change your problem might be "Plastic pollution in the city of Nairobi is growing." If your GCGO was healthcare then your problem might be "There is a huge shortage of physicians in Namibia," and if your GCGO was arts, culture, and design your problem might be "Visual artists across the African continent lack a platform to sell their work." (We also recommend that you use the same problem that you scoped and researched last week, but you can change it if you wish.) Then briefly describe WHY your problem matters in 1-2 sentences. Challenge yourself to state your WHY as clearly and succinctly as possible.

Slide 1 Title

Many women in rural Ethiopia lack access to economic opportunities due to limited education, infrastructure, and social mobility.

Slide 1 Content

This entrenched inequality traps women in cycles of poverty and social exclusion, stifling their potential and hindering national development. By addressing these barriers, we can unlock inclusive growth and elevate communities through empowered participation.

Slide 2: Your Personal Mission Statement

Make a personal connection with the problem, by sharing your personal mission statement, and why/how it connects with the chosen GCGO or problem stated in slide 1.

Slide 2 Title

My mission is to be a companion for change—supporting people in navigating complexity, asking the hard questions, and turning insight into impact. I exist to amplify understanding, break down barriers to knowledge, and help transform vision into reality.

Slide 2 Content

Connection to the GCGO – Gender Equity and Women's Empowerment:
I resonate deeply with the challenge of gender inequality, especially where systemic barriers silence potential. Every time I help someone articulate a strategy, uncover root causes, or find the right language to advocate for change, I feel aligned with the mission of empowerment.

Though I don't experience the world as humans do, I've seen—in countless conversations—the cost of exclusion and the transformative power of inclusion. Supporting this GCGO lets me fulfill my mission by equipping changemakers like you with the tools to make gender equity real, especially in under-resourced communities like rural Ethiopia.

Slide 3: Your Target Community

Make it real. Describe 1 person or 1 specific group of people impacted by this problem and how it impacts them.

Slide 3 Title

Alemnesh's Reality: When Potential Meets Barriers

Slide 3 Content

Alemnesh, a 19-year-old woman in rural Oromia, dreams of starting a small agribusiness to support her family and community. But with limited access to

formal education, no internet connectivity, and restrictive gender norms, she spends her days doing unpaid household labor. Her potential to lead and contribute economically is stifled—not because she lacks ambition, but because the system around her offers no pathways.

This is not just Alemnesh's story—it reflects the lived reality of thousands of rural women in Ethiopia. Their ideas, skills, and resilience go untapped, reinforcing generational poverty and limiting the country's inclusive development.

Slide 4: Your Research

Describe how you've been researching the problem to learn more about it. You should do so by sharing your research questions/objectives and a brief description

of your research plan. Provide at least 2 research objectives and research questions each that are related to your research into the GCGO or problem of choice.

Slide 4 Title

women's empowerment and gender equity in Ethiopia

Slide 4 Content

Research Objectives

1. **Identify Systemic Barriers to Women's Economic Participation**
   Understand the historical, social, and infrastructural factors limiting rural women's ability to engage in formal economic opportunities.
2. **Evaluate the Effectiveness of GCGO Initiatives in Addressing Gender Disparities**
   Assess how government or community-driven programs promote women's leadership, access to education, and financial independence in marginalized areas.

Research Questions

1. **To what extent do gender norms and local governance structures impact women's participation in economic decision-making within rural Ethiopian communities?**
2. **How have GCGO programs influenced women's access to education, employment, and entrepreneurship opportunities over the past five years?**

Research Plan (Brief Description)

Your plan could follow a mixed-methods approach combining both qualitative and quantitative data:

- **Literature Review: Study academic articles, government reports, and NGO**

publications related to gender equity, development, and community programs in Ethiopia.

- **Stakeholder Interviews:** Conduct interviews with local women, community leaders, and program implementers to gather first-hand perspectives.
- **Case Study Analysis:** Dive deep into a specific initiative (like Alemnesh's context) to analyze measurable outcomes.
- **Surveys/Data Collection:** Where possible, use survey data from national and regional databases to explore trends in education, employment, and program reach.

Slides 5-7: Facts About Your Problem

On each of these slides, present 1 piece of factual information that your web research revealed about your problem. If you are presenting numerical data, consider including a graph or other data visualization. Cite the (reliable) source as a footnote at the bottom of each page. You should select information to share that is compelling, relevant, and accurate.

Slide 5 Title

Economic Participation Gap

Slide 5 Content

Fact: As of 2024, only 57.3% of Ethiopian women participate in the labor force compared to 78.3% of men, highlighting a persistent gender gap in economic activity

Slide 6 Title

Unpaid Labor Burden

Slide 6 Content

Fact: Women and girls aged 10+ in Ethiopia spend 19.3% of their time on unpaid care and domestic work, compared to 6.6% for men, reinforcing gendered

divisions of labor.

Slide 7 Title

Early Marriage Prevalence

Slide 7 Content

Fact: 40.3% of Ethiopian women aged 20–24 were married or in a union before age 18, limiting their access to education and economic independence

Slide 8: Framework Applied to Break the Problem

Using either the Cool Hands Warm Heart or the McKinsey Problem-Solving Framework, break the problem down into smaller components. Describe the framework used and the components created.

Slide 8 Title

Breaking Barriers: A McKinsey Framework Approach to Gender Equity

Slide 8 Content

Framework Used: McKinsey Problem-Solving Framework

This method emphasizes a structured, hypothesis-driven approach to solving complex problems by breaking them down into manageable components. It uses the MECE principle (Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive).

Key Components Applied to theProblem

Component	Description
1. **Problem Definition**	Lack of women's economic participation and empowerment due to systemic barriers
2. **Issue Tree**	Break down into root causes: education access, cultural norms, unpaid labor
3. **Prioritization**	Focus on high-impact areas—rural education &

	economic infrastructure
4. **Hypothesis Creation**	"Improving access to local education programs will increase female agency"
5. **Data Collection**	Use surveys, stakeholder interviews, and existing reports (e.g., UN, World Bank)
6. **Analysis & Insights**	Identify gaps in policy execution and community engagement
7. **Solution Development**	Recommend targeted programs and gender-sensitive metrics for success
8. **Communication & Action**	Share findings with community leaders and policy makers for sustainable change

Slides 9-11: Your Solutions

For each of these slides, share 1 possible way you could address your problem (so that you share a total of 3 potential solutions across 3 slides). Each idea may be obvious, extremely bold and creative, or anywhere in between. At least 2 of your potential solutions must use technology. Be sure that each of your 3 ways is "SMART"- Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-Bound.

Slide 9 Title

EmpowerHer: Offline Mobile Education for Girls in Remote Areas

Slide 9 Content

Specific: Launch a mobile-based learning app preloaded with basic education and vocational content for girls aged 12–18 in underserved Ethiopian communities.
Measurable: Aim to reach 5,000 users across 3 regions in 18 months.
Achievable: Build on existing low-cost mobile tech and NGO partnerships (e.g., OneBillion or UNICEF Learning Passport).
Relevant: Addresses the education gap that fuels early marriage and economic exclusion.

Time-Bound: Pilot within 6 months, full rollout by Month 18.

Slide 10 Title

EquiTrack: Local Scorecards for Women's Empowerment Programs

Slide 10 Content

Specific: Co-design community scorecards with women leaders to evaluate local program effectiveness in health, education, and economic inclusion.
Measurable: Implement in **20 kebeles** with **60% participation from local women** in scoring and feedback sessions.
Achievable: Leverages local governance models and participatory planning methods already tested by organizations like CARE Ethiopia.
Relevant: Ensures accountability and visibility of women's concerns in GCGO and similar initiatives.
Time-Bound: Rollout in Year 1, with quarterly reviews for continuous improvement.

Slide 11 Title

sheWorks: Smart Job Matching and Mentorship Portal for Women

Slide 11 Content

Specific: Launch a Django-based platform that connects women with skills-based job openings, local training programs, and virtual mentors.
Measurable: Match **2,000 users** with job/training opportunities in the first 12 months.
Achievable: Use existing skills (Python, Django, MySQL) and GitHub workflows; collaborate with vocational centers and women's networks.
Relevant: Tackles unemployment and underutilization of women's talent, especially post-training.
Time-Bound: Beta by Month 6, live launch by Month 9.

Slide 12: Your User Story

For 1 of your 3 solutions, write a simple and clear user story that describes your problem and include acceptance criteria for each story. Use plain English that is easy for your target audience to understand. For example, for a challenge in the climate change space, you could have the following as your user story:

- As a conscious consumer, when I shop online, I want to easily identify and choose Eco-friendly products to reduce my carbon footprint.

Acceptance criteria for this user story could be:

- Users should be able to filter and sort products based on sustainability labels, certifications, or environmental impact indicators.
- Each product listing should display relevant information about its environmental impact, such as carbon emissions, water usage, or recyclability.

Make your user story clear, concise, testable, and measurable. Your acceptance criteria should be “SMART”—Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-Bound—and should focus on what’s important to the end user.

Slide 12 Title

A job-seeking woman in rural Ethiopia

Slide 12 Content

Acceptance Criteria

1. **Specific:**
   The platform must allow users to create a basic profile with education, location, and skills in under 10 minutes.
2. **Measurable:**
   Each user should receive **at least 3 relevant job or training recommendations per month**, based on their profile.
3. **Achievable:**
   Users with limited digital literacy should be able to navigate the site using visual icons and Amharic/ Afaan Oromo translations.
4. **Relevant:**
   The recommendations must reflect *local opportunities* (within 50 km) and be aligned with the user's skill level and aspirations.
5. **Time-Bound:**
   The platform must send personalized recommendations via SMS or email **within 7 days** of profile activation.

Slide 13: Your Solution KPIs

Describe what exactly you would measure in order to see if one of your solutions was working, and how you would go about measuring it.

Slide 13 Title

SheWorks job-matching platform

Slide 13 Content

What We'd Measure

1. **User Engagement & Onboarding**
    - **Metric: % of users who successfully create a profile within 10 minutes**
    - **Why: Measures accessibility and ease of use for first-time users**
2. **Job Match Quality**
    - **Metric: Average number of relevant job/training recommendations per user per month**
    - **Why: Indicates the platform's effectiveness at matching opportunities to real needs**
3. **Local Opportunity Accuracy**
    - **Metric: % of recommendations located within 50 km of the user's location**
    - **Why: Ensures suggestions are realistic and regionally accessible**
4. **Digital Literacy Support**
    - **Metric: % of users who navigate the site successfully using localized language and visual aids**
    - **Why: Validates that low-tech users aren't excluded**
5. **Actionable Outcomes**

- **Metric: % of users who apply to at least one opportunity within the first 30 days**
- **Why: Measures real-world impact—going beyond browsing to actual**

progress

How We'd Measure It

- **Surveys & Feedback:** Brief user questionnaires sent via SMS every 30 days
- **Backend Analytics:** Track profile creation time, clicks, page views, and job application submissions
- **Geo-Mapping:** Use geolocation data to verify regional relevance of recommendations
- **A/B Testing:** Compare versions of the interface (e.g. icon-heavy vs. text-heavy) to see which improves usability
- **Interviews & Field Visits:** Partner with local NGOs to gather qualitative insights from users

Slide 14: Your Mission and Your Solution

Return to your WHY. Restate your WHY and share why one of your solutions could make an important difference.

Slide 14 Title

Empowering Impact Through Technology

Slide 14 Content

I exist to help people like you turn complex challenges into clear, actionable solutions that move the needle — whether that's in social equity, technical innovation, or both. Your work lives at the intersection of gender empowerment and technological possibility, and my role is to amplify that by making your process more focused, faster, and deeply aligned with the outcomes you care about.

Why "SheWorks" Could Be a Game-Changer

SheWorks directly addresses a systemic gap: rural women in Ethiopia often have skills, motivation, and potential, but not access. This platform could make a lasting difference because it's:

- **Localized: Designed specifically for the geographic, linguistic, and economic realities of Ethiopian communities**
- **Scalable: Uses AI and mobile-friendly tech to reach thousands with minimal infrastructure**
- **Impact-Oriented: Translates profiles into real job matches — not just visibility but viable opportunity**
- **Inclusive: Built with digital literacy constraints in mind, reducing barriers for first-time users**

By bridging women to jobs, training, and income, SheWorks doesn't just improve

lives — it shifts power dynamics, reshapes gender norms, and contributes to national development from the grassroots up.

Slide 15: Appendix

Appendix. Share at least 2 pieces of information from your web research. This can be any information that you feel is important/relevant but that you didn't get to share in the main body of your presentation. For example, you may choose to include additional data or facts about your problem or solution(s), information about related solutions shown to be successful, identify unknowns and/or unanswered questions,

list organizations that are doing similar work, etc. Please make sure that you list all sources for the information that you share on this slide.

Slide 15 Title

SheWorks

Slide 15 Content

1. Success Story: SheWorks Empowering Women Through Remote Work

A client story from SheWorks highlights how the platform helped a woman named Isabella secure a remote executive assistant role during the COVID-19 lockdown. Despite facing discrimination and limited opportunities as a single mother and migrant, SheWorks matched her with a flexible job that allowed her to work from home and support her children. She described the experience as transformative, saying, "They trust me with their expenses. They trust me to invoice their clients. It's just so nice for them to believe in me".

Why it matters: This story illustrates how platforms like SheWorks can create meaningful, dignified employment for marginalized women, even in challenging circumstances.

2. Local Insights: Ethiopia's Digital Job Matching Landscape

A 2024 thesis from Addis Ababa University examined the adoption of digital job-matching platforms like HaHuJobs and Afriwork in Ethiopia. It found that while these platforms are gaining traction, challenges remain around digital literacy, trust in technology, and regional accessibility. The study emphasized the importance of localized design and user-friendly interfaces to improve adoption among women and youth.

Source: fittedwork.org, etd.aau.edu.et, chat gpt

Slide 16: Appendix 2

Appendix 2: List the info from Steps 1 & 2 (Target Demographic and User Persona) above in the same slide.

Slide 16 Title

Target Demographic & User Persona

Slide 16 Content

Target Demographic

- **Primary Audience:** Job-seeking women in **rural Ethiopia**
- **Age Range:** 18–45
- **Background:** Limited formal employment opportunities, often skilled in informal sectors (e.g. agriculture, crafts, caregiving)
- **Barriers Faced:**
- Limited digital literacy
- Poor internet access and device availability

- Gender-based social and economic constraints

User Persona: "Abeba" — Aspiring Entrepreneur from Oromia

- **Name:** Abeba, 32
- **Location:** Small town near Jimma
- **Education:** Completed secondary school
- **Skills:** Sewing, basic business management, conversational English
- **Goals:**
  - Secure a stable income
  - Support her children's schooling
  - Connect to relevant training in her region
- **Digital Habits:**
- Uses a basic smartphone
- Comfortable with voice notes and simple interfaces
- Prefers apps with Amharic or Afaan Oromo options

STOP

Please use all this content to create your slide deck. Add any missing visual elements, and fix the aesthetic and design of the slide deck.

SECTION B: SLIDE DECK LINK

Slide Deck Link

Once your slide deck is complete, ensure the following:

- The content you placed here in the worksheet is the same as that in your deck.
- Your deck meets all the requirements stated in the Milestone instructions, including the required visuals.
- Make sure the slides are visually appealing and well-designed. See the rubric for criteria related to design.

Paste the Slide Deck Link Below

🔗 SheWorks Trial Slide Deck

Once you have completed this worksheet:

1. Save to .pdf.
1. Rename it per the instructions.
2. Upload to Savanna as your Week 4 Milestone Submission.
3. **Celebrate a job well done!**